

HOSTING AND RECURRING COSTS

Parts Portal: Hosting Options and Recurring Costs

Hosting options compared, with recurring infrastructure costs for each.

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Currency: All figures in Canadian dollars

1. Hosting Options

Four options worth considering. They differ in price, in who owns the company holding our data, and in how much technical work falls on us.

On the figures: all of these should be quoted properly before any decision. Where a provider publishes list prices, those are shown and can be checked on their website today. Where a provider does not, an approximate figure is given so that the options can be compared at all, but these are rough and should be treated as an order of magnitude rather than a budget.

Option A: ThinkOn (Canada)

Data centre	Canadian. Head office, Etobicoke, Ontario.
Ownership	Canadian. Our data would be subject only to Canadian law. Canada's first VMware Sovereign Cloud Partner, and an approved supplier under Shared Services Canada frameworks.
Services	Virtual Private Cloud, Private Cloud, Dedicated Bare Metal. Backup through Veeam or Commvault. Object storage. No ingress or egress fees, so moving our own data never costs us.
Cost	Not published. ThinkOn sells only through channel partners, so a quote must be arranged. Allow 2 to 3 weeks.
Approximate	Possibly in the range of \$300 to \$600 per month, roughly \$3,600 to \$7,200 per year, on their Virtual Private Cloud tier, including backup and storage. This is a rough figure only. See the note below.
Verdict	The only option offering genuine Canadian sovereignty. Likely the most expensive. Needs a quote before it can be compared properly.

A caution on that figure. It is not a quote and should not be relied on. ThinkOn publishes prices only for the public sector, and notes that the Ontario public sector receives a 50% discount from that list, so we cannot read our own price off it. The approximation above was reached from what is documented: they bill their Virtual Private Cloud in units of 1 GHz of CPU and 2 GB of RAM, our workload needs roughly 12 GB of RAM and 250 GB of storage, and sovereign cloud built on VMware generally costs several times a commodity server for the same specification because the price carries the licensing, the certifications, the sovereignty guarantees and the support. Their Private Cloud tier is not costed here because its minimum commitment of 80 GB of virtual RAM and 1 TB of storage is roughly seven times what we need, and we would be paying for capacity we would never use. The real number could reasonably come in above or below the range shown, and the only way to know is to ask a partner.

Option B: OVHcloud (Canada)

Data centre	Beauharnois, Quebec
Ownership	French (OVH SAS). Not subject to the US CLOUD Act, but subject to French and EU law. Canadian residency, not Canadian sovereignty.

Cost	\$16.83/month for the server (6 vCores, 12 GB RAM, 100 GB NVMe). Daily backup, anti-DDoS, 99.9% SLA and unlimited traffic included. Premium backup from \$1.80/month. These are published list prices and can be verified today.
All-in	Approx. \$25 to \$40/month, or \$300 to \$500/year, including object storage for the diagrams and off-site backup copies.
We manage	The server. Operating system patching and updates fall to us or to a support retainer.
Verdict	Cheapest by a wide margin, Canadian data centre, published pricing, non-US. The trade is French ownership rather than Canadian.

Option C: AWS, Microsoft Azure or Google Cloud (Canada)

Data centre	Montreal, Toronto or Quebec City
Ownership	US. Subject to the US CLOUD Act even for data held in Canada. Residency yes, sovereignty no.
Cost	Roughly \$80 to \$150/month for server, managed database, storage and data transfer. Approximate. Their calculators give exact figures once a specification is fixed. Egress charges apply to our own data leaving the platform.
All-in	Roughly \$1,000 to \$1,800/year. Approximate.
We manage	Less, if managed database services are used.
Verdict	Three to four times Option B, with a weaker legal position than either A or B. Not recommended, included for completeness.

Option D: Managed database (add-on to A, B or C)

What it is	The provider runs and patches the database rather than us. Available from most providers including OVHcloud and the major platforms.
Cost	Roughly \$30 to \$80/month on top of Option B. Approximate, needs quoting.
Why consider it	Removes a category of technical work from us. Worth pricing given that neither of us is a database administrator.
Verdict	Not necessary at our scale, but sensible to quote alongside whichever option we choose.

Comparison

Option	Per year	Canadian DC	Canadian owned	Price published
A. ThinkOn	\$3,600 to \$7,200 approx.	Yes	Yes	No, quote needed
B. OVHcloud	\$300 to \$500	Yes	No (French)	Yes
C. AWS / Azure / GCP	\$1,000 to \$1,800 approx.	Yes	No (US)	Yes

D. Managed DB add-on	Add \$400 to \$1,000 approx.	Yes	Depends	Partly
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Suggested next step: get real quotes for Options A and B and put the two side by side. Option C is included for completeness and is not recommended. Everything above is approximate until those quotes are in hand.

The decision this comes down to: both A and B hold our data in a Canadian data centre. The difference is that ThinkOn is Canadian-owned and therefore answers only to Canadian law, while OVHcloud is French-owned, which puts our data outside US reach but not outside French and EU reach. On the rough figures above, that difference costs somewhere around \$3,000 to \$6,700 a year. Whether Canadian ownership is worth that for a parts catalog is a judgement for management rather than a technical question, and the quotes will tell us whether the gap is really that wide.

2. Recurring Costs

Broken down against Option B, OVHcloud, because it is the only option with published prices we can show today. The same line items apply to Option A, at figures to be confirmed by quote.

Item	Cost	Notes
Cloud hosting	\$16.83/month	Option B, OVHcloud published price. Server runs the portal and the database.
Database hosting	\$0	Runs on the same server. A separate managed service is Option D if we want it.
Backup services	\$1.80 to \$2.30/month	Daily backup included free. Premium 7-day backup from \$1.80. Snapshots from \$0.50.
Object storage	\$5 to \$15/month	Diagram images and off-site backup copies. Estimate, depends on volume.
Domain	\$0 to \$40/year	Nil if we use parts.rufdiamond.com on the domain we already own.
SSL certificate	\$0	Free through Let's Encrypt, renews automatically.
Software licensing	\$0	PostgreSQL, Linux and the web server are open source. No licence fee, now or as we grow.
Technical support	Quote required	Server patching, backup monitoring, incident response. Quote required.
Infrastructure total	\$25 to \$40/month	Approx. \$300 to \$500/year on Option B, excluding support. Option A would be higher, subject to quote.